domestic bases. While normatively appealing to many nonpopulists, especially those in favor of globalization, this strategy is likely to accelerate populist disengagement from the IO.

In this situation, populist leaders are deprived of influence, and constituents are denied recognition or material benefits. Consequently, neither the elites nor the populist public sees continued IO participation as worthwhile. This increases the likelihood of defection, noncompliance, or active sabotage from within. Taken to the extreme, it may result in formal withdrawal or the creation of parallel institutions that better reflect the populist agenda. Importantly, disengagement may not reduce the IO's vulnerability to populist attacks; in fact, exclusion may feed domestic narratives of victimization and illegitimacy.

A third combination of strategies allows IOs to appease populist leaders while sidelining their constituents. This strategy may involve granting policy concessions, elevating populist leaders into prestigious roles, or allowing rule-bending behavior in exchange for continued cooperation. At the same time, IOs may neglect public outreach, engagement with civil society, or social investment within populist-led states, working out of public view or actively supporting nonpopulist members of the public.

This asymmetric accommodation risks empowering leaders while ignoring the grievances and expectations of the public that brought them to power. While such an arrangement may reduce public pressure for withdrawal or confrontation, it creates a permissive environment for elite manipulation and democratic backsliding. If leaders are excessively appeased, the boundary between participation and co-optation becomes thin, which can delegitimize the IO in the eyes of both populist and nonpopulist audiences.

Finally, IOs may sideline populist leaders while continuing to engage and appease their constituents. This could take the form of direct communication with civil society, investment in subnational projects, or policies that address populist voters' material concerns. Though such efforts may be met with elite hostility, they can help sustain public support for the IO.

In this configuration, the IO may experience low-level populist obstruction but avoid full-scale defection or delegitimation. By cultivating popular legitimacy even without the buy-in of populist leaders, IOs can